

READ TO SPEAK

REAL ENGLISH.
REAL **PROGRESS.**

B1

CORE
Intermediate

B1

CORE

Build your core.
Express with
confidence.



Engaging passages
on real-life topics



15 target words with
in-context meanings



Word-tracking grid –
your signature method



Speaking prompts to
express your ideas



Grammar focus drawn
from the passage



— by —
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READ TO SPEAK

B1 — Core

Intermediate

Reflective and personal topics. Vocabulary connects to real conversations about emotions, work, and growth.

12	15	200–250
units	words per unit	words per passage

Each unit contains:

- A rich, engaging passage on a meaningful topic
- 15 target words with in-context meanings
- Word-tracking grid, your signature method
- Speaking prompts designed to activate the vocabulary
- Grammar focus drawn directly from the passage
- Review unit every 3 units, recycling vocabulary

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Unit 1 · Resilience · The tree that bends

There is an old saying that a tree which does not bend will break. For years, I did not truly understand what this meant. I thought strength was about staying firm, refusing to move, refusing to show that something had affected you. I was wrong.

Real resilience is not about pretending that difficult things do not happen. It is about your ability to adapt, to accept what has happened and keep moving forward. When we face a challenge, the first instinct is often to resist it, to fight against the discomfort. But this resistance can sometimes make things harder.

People who recover well from setbacks are not people who never feel pain. They are people who allow themselves to feel it, and then gradually find their way back. They do not dwell on what went wrong for too long. Instead, they ask: what can I learn from this? What can I adjust?

This kind of thinking does not come naturally to everyone. It is a skill you can develop. Like a muscle, it grows stronger each time you use it. Every time you endure a hard moment and come out the other side, you build a little more capacity to handle the next one.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
affected	<i>verb (past p.)</i>	Had an emotional or physical impact on you	<i>The loss deeply affected her.</i>
adapt	<i>verb</i>	Change your behaviour to suit a new situation	<i>You must adapt to survive.</i>
face	<i>verb</i>	Deal with something difficult directly	<i>He had to face the consequences.</i>
instinct	<i>noun</i>	A natural reaction you have without thinking	<i>My instinct was to run.</i>
resist	<i>verb</i>	Push back against something; refuse to accept it	<i>She resisted the urge to quit.</i>
recover	<i>verb</i>	Return to a normal state after something difficult	<i>It took months to recover.</i>
setbacks	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Difficulties or failures that slow your progress	<i>Every journey has setbacks.</i>
gradually	<i>adverb</i>	Slowly, over a period of time	<i>Things gradually got better.</i>
dwell	<i>verb</i>	Spend too much time thinking about something negative	<i>Don't dwell on the past.</i>
adjust	<i>verb</i>	Make small changes to improve a situation	<i>I adjusted my approach.</i>
naturally	<i>adverb</i>	Easily, without effort; as part of your character	<i>It didn't come naturally.</i>

develop	<i>verb</i>	Build and improve something over time	<i>You can develop resilience.</i>
endure	<i>verb</i>	Go through something painful without giving up	<i>She endured years of hardship.</i>
capacity	<i>noun</i>	The ability or power to do or experience something	<i>He has a great capacity for patience.</i>
handle	<i>verb</i>	Deal with or manage a situation effectively	<i>She handled it well.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
affected	<i>verb (past p.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
adapt	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
face	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
instinct	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
resist	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
recover	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
setbacks	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
gradually	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
dwell	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
adjust	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
naturally	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
develop	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
endure	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
capacity	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
handle	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	Complete → move to next unit

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1 Describe a time you faced a major setback. How did you recover?

2	Do you think resilience is something you are born with or something you develop? Why?
3	What helps you adjust when things don't go as planned?
4	Talk about someone you know who handles difficulties well. What do they do differently?

Grammar focus

Contrast with 'but' and 'however'

The passage contrasts ideas using 'but': 'I thought strength was about staying firm... But this resistance can make things harder.' 'However' is more formal and usually begins a new sentence. Both express contrast.

Examples from the passage context:

- She was tired, but she kept going.
- However, the results were better than expected.
- I wanted to resist, but I adapted instead.
- He struggled. However, he never gave up.

Practice task:

Write 3 pairs of contrasting sentences using 'but' or 'however'. Use ideas from the passage.

Write your answers here:

Unit 2 · Solitude · The gift of being alone

Most people are uncomfortable with silence. We fill every quiet moment with noise, music, podcasts, scrolling through our phones. We have forgotten how to simply be with ourselves.

But solitude, the experience of being alone by choice, is not the same as loneliness. Loneliness is a feeling of disconnection from others. Solitude is a conscious decision to spend time alone in order to rest, reflect, and recharge.

Many creative and thoughtful people throughout history have valued solitude deeply. Writers, philosophers, and scientists have all spoken about how time alone allowed them to think more clearly and produce their best work.

When you spend time alone without distraction, you begin to hear your own thoughts more clearly. You become aware of what you truly value and what worries you. Solitude is not an escape from life, it is a way of understanding it better.

Try giving yourself twenty minutes of quiet each day. No phone. No music. Just you and your thoughts. You may be surprised by what you discover.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
solitude	<i>noun</i>	The state of being alone, especially by choice	<i>She valued solitude for reflection.</i>
loneliness	<i>noun</i>	The feeling of being alone and disconnected	<i>Loneliness can affect your health.</i>
conscious	<i>adjective</i>	Deliberate and intentional; done with awareness	<i>It was a conscious decision.</i>
reflect	<i>verb</i>	To think carefully and deeply about something	<i>Take time to reflect on your choices.</i>
recharge	<i>verb</i>	To restore your energy after being tired	<i>I need solitude to recharge.</i>
distraction	<i>noun</i>	Something that prevents you from concentrating	<i>Phones are a constant distraction.</i>
aware	<i>adjective</i>	Having knowledge or understanding of something	<i>Be aware of your own feelings.</i>
value	<i>verb</i>	To consider something important or precious	<i>I value my quiet time.</i>
escape	<i>noun</i>	A way to get away from something difficult	<i>Reading is an escape for me.</i>
discover	<i>verb</i>	To find or learn something new	<i>Silence helps you discover yourself.</i>
disconnection	<i>noun</i>	The state of not feeling connected to others	<i>Social media can cause disconnection.</i>
thoughtful	<i>adjective</i>	Thinking carefully; considerate of others	<i>She is a thoughtful person.</i>

throughout	<i>preposition</i>	In every part of; from beginning to end	<i>Throughout history, solitude was valued.</i>
silence	<i>noun</i>	Complete absence of sound	<i>Sit in silence for a few minutes.</i>
simply	<i>adverb</i>	In a basic way; without complication	<i>Try to simply be present.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
solitude	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
loneliness	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
conscious	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
reflect	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
recharge	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
distraction	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
aware	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
value	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
escape	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
discover	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
disconnection	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
thoughtful	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
throughout	<i>preposition</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
silence	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
simply	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	Do you enjoy spending time alone? How does it make you feel?
2	What is the difference between solitude and loneliness in your experience?
3	How do you recharge when you feel mentally tired?

4 What distracts you most in daily life? How do you deal with it?

Grammar focus

In order to / so that, expressing purpose

We use 'in order to' and 'so that' to explain the purpose of an action. 'In order to' is followed by the infinitive. 'So that' is followed by a clause with a subject.

Examples from the passage context:

- She takes walks in order to reflect.
- He turns off his phone so that he can focus.
- I journal in order to understand my feelings.
- She leaves early so that she has time alone.

Practice task:

Write 3 sentences explaining why you do something, using 'in order to' or 'so that'.

Write your answers here:

Unit 3 · Ambition · Wanting more

Ambition is often seen as a positive quality, a sign that someone wants to grow and achieve great things. But ambition can also be complicated. When does healthy ambition become an obsession? When does drive become pressure?

Some people are highly ambitious from a young age. They set big goals, work long hours, and sacrifice other parts of their life in pursuit of success. For some, this approach brings great reward. For others, it leads to exhaustion, broken relationships, and a feeling that nothing is ever enough.

The question worth asking is not 'Am I ambitious enough?' but 'What am I actually ambitious for?' Many people discover, later in life, that they were chasing goals set by others, by parents, by society, or by comparison with peers, rather than goals that were truly their own.

Ambition is most powerful when it is aligned with your values. When you pursue something that genuinely matters to you, the effort feels meaningful rather than exhausting. The goal is not to eliminate ambition, but to make sure it is pointing in the right direction.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
ambition	<i>noun</i>	A strong desire to achieve something	<i>Her ambition drove her forward.</i>
obsession	<i>noun</i>	An unhealthy fixation on one thing	<i>Success became an obsession.</i>
sacrifice	<i>verb</i>	To give up something valuable for something else	<i>He sacrificed sleep for work.</i>
pursuit	<i>noun</i>	The act of trying to achieve something	<i>The pursuit of happiness.</i>
exhaustion	<i>noun</i>	Extreme tiredness	<i>Overwork leads to exhaustion.</i>
comparison	<i>noun</i>	The act of measuring one thing against another	<i>Avoid comparison with others.</i>
peers	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	People of the same age or social group	<i>He felt pressure from his peers.</i>
aligned	<i>adjective</i>	In agreement with; pointing in the same direction	<i>Your goals should be aligned with your values.</i>
values	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	The things you believe are most important in life	<i>Honesty is one of my core values.</i>
genuinely	<i>adverb</i>	Truly and sincerely; not pretending	<i>She genuinely cares about people.</i>
meaningful	<i>adjective</i>	Having purpose and significance	<i>I want meaningful work.</i>
eliminate	<i>verb</i>	To completely remove or get rid of something	<i>You can't eliminate all stress.</i>
reward	<i>noun</i>	Something gained as a result of effort	<i>Hard work brings its own reward.</i>
drive	<i>noun</i>	Strong motivation and determination	<i>She has incredible drive.</i>

discover	<i>verb</i>	To find or learn something you didn't know before	<i>I discovered what I really wanted.</i>
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Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
ambition	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
obsession	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
sacrifice	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
pursuit	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
exhaustion	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
comparison	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
peers	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
aligned	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
values	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
genuinely	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
meaningful	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
eliminate	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
reward	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
drive	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
discover	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	What are you ambitious for? Is it something you chose or something you felt expected to want?
2	How do you know when ambition has become unhealthy?
3	Talk about something you sacrificed for a goal. Was it worth it?
4	What does 'success' mean to you personally?

Grammar focus

Rhetorical questions

The passage uses rhetorical questions, questions not meant to be answered directly, but to make the reader think: 'When does drive become pressure?' 'What am I actually ambitious for?' These are powerful in speaking and writing.

Examples from the passage context:

- What does success really mean?
- How long can you ignore what matters?
- When does hard work become self-destruction?
- Is ambition always a good thing?

Practice task:

Write 2 rhetorical questions about ambition, goals, or success that could start a discussion.

Write your answers here:

Review Unit 1

Recycling vocabulary from Unit 1, Unit 2, Unit 3

Mixed tracking grid

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

Word	1	2	3	4	5	Sentence using the word
affected	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
instinct	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
setbacks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
adjust	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
endure	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
solitude	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
reflect	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
aware	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
discover	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
throughout	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
ambition	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
pursuit	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
peers	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
genuinely	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
reward	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Cumulative speaking challenge

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

Words I used: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____	Self-assessment: How naturally did you use the words? ☐ Very naturally ☐ Mostly well ☐ Needs more practice Notes: _____ _____ _____
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Unit 4 · Identity · Who are you, really?

Identity is one of the most complex questions a person can explore. Who are you? Are you the roles you play, a parent, a colleague, a friend? Are you your nationality, your religion, your job? Or are you something underneath all of that?

For many people, identity feels fixed, something given to them by their background, their family, or their culture. But identity is rarely as fixed as it seems. Most people change significantly over the course of their lives.

The psychologist Erik Erikson argued that identity is not something you find, it is something you construct, through choices, experiences, and reflection. Each major decision you make is also a statement about who you are and who you want to become.

This idea can feel frightening or liberating, depending on how you look at it. If identity is constructed, then you are not stuck. You are not defined by your past. But you are also responsible for who you are becoming. Every choice you make is part of that ongoing story.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
identity	<i>noun</i>	Who or what a person is; your sense of self	<i>She struggled with her identity.</i>
complex	<i>adjective</i>	Having many connected parts; not simple	<i>It's a complex issue.</i>
explore	<i>verb</i>	To investigate and think deeply about	<i>Explore your own values and beliefs.</i>
fixed	<i>adjective</i>	Not changing; permanent	<i>Your identity is not fixed.</i>
background	<i>noun</i>	Your family, culture, and past experiences	<i>We all come from different backgrounds.</i>
construct	<i>verb</i>	To build or create something over time	<i>We construct our identities through choices.</i>
reflection	<i>noun</i>	Serious thought about one's own character and actions	<i>Journalling encourages reflection.</i>
statement	<i>noun</i>	An expression of a belief or attitude	<i>Your choices make a statement.</i>
liberating	<i>adjective</i>	Making you feel free and unrestricted	<i>That realisation was liberating.</i>
frightening	<i>adjective</i>	Causing fear or worry	<i>The uncertainty was frightening.</i>
responsible	<i>adjective</i>	Having a duty to deal with something	<i>You are responsible for your choices.</i>
defined	<i>verb (past p.)</i>	Described or limited by something	<i>Don't be defined by your past.</i>
ongoing	<i>adjective</i>	Continuing; still happening	<i>It's an ongoing process.</i>
underneath	<i>preposition</i>	Beneath; at a deeper level	<i>What is underneath that feeling?</i>

significantly	<i>adverb</i>	In a way that is important and noticeable	<i>People change significantly over time.</i>
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Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
identity	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
complex	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
explore	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
fixed	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
background	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
construct	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
reflection	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
statement	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
liberating	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
frightening	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
responsible	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
defined	<i>verb (past p.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
ongoing	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
underneath	<i>preposition</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
significantly	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	How would you describe your identity? What is the most important part of who you are?
2	Do you think people can truly change who they are? Why or why not?
3	Has your sense of identity changed since you were younger? How?
4	Are you more defined by your background or your choices? Explain.

Grammar focus

Passive voice, being defined, constructed, given

The passage uses the passive voice: 'identity is not something you find, it is something you construct'. The passive is formed with be + past participle. We use it when the action is more important than who does it.

Examples from the passage context:

- Identity is shaped by experience.
- Your choices are not determined by your past.
- He was raised in two cultures.
- She felt defined by her job.

Practice task:

Rewrite 3 active sentences about identity as passive sentences. Then write 2 original passive sentences.

Write your answers here:

Unit 5 · Courage · Small acts of bravery

When we think of courage, we often imagine dramatic moments, a firefighter rushing into a burning building, or a soldier on a battlefield. But most of us will never face those situations. Does that mean we never need courage?

Not at all. Courage shows up in much quieter ways in everyday life. It takes courage to say no when everyone around you is saying yes. It takes courage to admit you were wrong. It takes courage to begin again after failure.

Psychologists make a distinction between physical courage and moral courage. Physical courage is the ability to act despite bodily danger. Moral courage is the ability to act on your values even when it is uncomfortable or unpopular to do so.

Most of us need moral courage far more than physical courage. The ability to have an honest conversation, to set a boundary, or to speak up for something you believe in, these are the acts of bravery that shape the kind of person you become.

Courage is not the absence of fear. It is the decision that something else matters more.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
courage	<i>noun</i>	The ability to do something despite fear or difficulty	<i>It takes courage to be honest.</i>
dramatic	<i>adjective</i>	Exciting and impressive; having a strong effect	<i>The change was dramatic.</i>
distinction	<i>noun</i>	A difference or contrast between two things	<i>There is a distinction between bravery and recklessness.</i>
moral	<i>adjective</i>	Relating to principles of right and wrong	<i>She made a moral decision.</i>
despite	<i>preposition</i>	Without being prevented by; even though	<i>She spoke despite her fear.</i>
uncomfortable	<i>adjective</i>	Making you feel slightly worried or embarrassed	<i>The silence was uncomfortable.</i>
unpopular	<i>adjective</i>	Not liked or agreed with by most people	<i>She made an unpopular decision.</i>
boundary	<i>noun</i>	A limit on what is acceptable in a relationship	<i>It's important to set boundaries.</i>
absence	<i>noun</i>	The state of not being there or not existing	<i>Courage is not the absence of fear.</i>
admit	<i>verb</i>	To say that something is true, especially when embarrassing	<i>He admitted he was wrong.</i>
failure	<i>noun</i>	The fact of not achieving what was intended	<i>Failure is part of learning.</i>

shape	<i>verb</i>	To influence and determine what something becomes	<i>Choices shape who you become.</i>
bravery	<i>noun</i>	Courageous behaviour or character	<i>Small acts of bravery matter.</i>
honest	<i>adjective</i>	Truthful; not hiding the truth	<i>Be honest with yourself.</i>
imagination	<i>noun</i>	The ability to form pictures or ideas in the mind	<i>Use your imagination to solve problems.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
courage	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
dramatic	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
distinction	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
moral	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
despite	<i>preposition</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
uncomfortable	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
unpopular	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
boundary	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
absence	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
admit	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
failure	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
shape	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
bravery	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
honest	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
imagination	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1

Describe a time you needed courage in everyday life. What happened?

- | | |
|---|--|
| 2 | What is harder for you, physical courage or moral courage? Why? |
| 3 | Have you ever had to set a boundary or say no to something? How did it feel? |
| 4 | Do you think courage can be learned or is it natural? |

Grammar focus

It takes + noun/adjective to + infinitive

The pattern 'It takes [something] to [do something]' is used to describe what is required to do something: 'It takes courage to admit you were wrong.' This pattern is very natural in spoken English.

Examples from the passage context:

- It takes patience to learn a language.
- It takes honesty to admit a mistake.
- It takes time to build real confidence.
- It doesn't take much to make someone feel heard.

Practice task:

Write 4 sentences using the pattern 'It takes ... to ...' about things that require courage, effort, or skill.

Write your answers here:

Unit 6 · Grief and loss · Learning to let go

Loss is one of the most universal human experiences. We lose people we love, jobs we valued, versions of ourselves we had grown attached to. And yet, despite how common loss is, we are rarely taught how to grieve.

Grief is not a linear process. It does not move from point A to point B in a straight line. People move back and forth between different emotional states, sadness, anger, numbness, acceptance, sometimes within a single day.

One of the most difficult parts of grief is the feeling that you should be 'over it' by now. There is no timeline for grief. Some losses take years to fully integrate. What changes over time is not that you feel less, but that the pain gradually becomes part of your story rather than the whole of it.

Letting go does not mean forgetting. It means releasing the grip that the loss has on you, the way it controls your thoughts and prevents you from being present. You can carry the memory of someone with love without being consumed by the absence of them.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
universal	<i>adjective</i>	Experienced by everyone; applying to all cases	<i>Loss is a universal experience.</i>
grieve	<i>verb</i>	To feel deep sadness after a loss	<i>It is okay to grieve.</i>
linear	<i>adjective</i>	Moving in a straight line; step by step	<i>Grief is not a linear process.</i>
numbness	<i>noun</i>	A feeling of not being able to feel emotions	<i>After the shock came numbness.</i>
acceptance	<i>noun</i>	The act of accepting a difficult situation as it is	<i>Acceptance takes time.</i>
integrate	<i>verb</i>	To include and absorb something into your life	<i>Over time, you integrate loss.</i>
releasing	<i>verb</i>	Letting go of something you have been holding	<i>She is releasing old pain.</i>
consumed	<i>adjective</i>	Completely taken over by a feeling or thought	<i>He was consumed by grief.</i>
presence	<i>noun</i>	The state of being in a place or moment	<i>Stay present in difficult moments.</i>
attached	<i>adjective</i>	Having a strong emotional connection to something	<i>She was deeply attached to her home.</i>
gradually	<i>adverb</i>	Slowly, over a period of time	<i>The pain gradually becomes manageable.</i>
timeline	<i>noun</i>	A plan or sequence showing when things happen	<i>There is no timeline for healing.</i>
absence	<i>noun</i>	The state of not being there	<i>The absence was painful.</i>

carry	<i>verb</i>	To hold something with you, physically or emotionally	<i>Carry the good memories with you.</i>
prevent	<i>verb</i>	To stop something from happening	<i>Grief can prevent you from moving forward.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
universal	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
grieve	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
linear	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
numbness	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
acceptance	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
integrate	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
releasing	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
consumed	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
presence	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
attached	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
gradually	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
timeline	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
absence	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
carry	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
prevent	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							<u>/75</u>	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	Have you experienced a significant loss? How did you cope?
2	What does 'letting go' mean to you? Is it the same as forgetting?
3	Why do you think people feel pressure to grieve in a certain way or in a certain time?

4 How do you support someone who is going through grief?

Grammar focus

Without + -ing

We use 'without + -ing' to describe something happening in the absence of another action: 'without being consumed', 'without forgetting'. It shows two things are separate.

Examples from the passage context:

- You can grieve without losing hope.
- She moved on without forgetting.
- He spoke without showing his pain.
- You can remember without being consumed.

Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'without + -ing' about loss, change, or personal growth.

Write your answers here:

Review Unit 2

Recycling vocabulary from Unit 4, Unit 5, Unit 6

Mixed tracking grid

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

Word	1	2	3	4	5	Sentence using the word
identity	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
fixed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
reflection	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
frightening	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
ongoing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
courage	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
moral	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
unpopular	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
admit	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
bravery	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
universal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
numbness	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
releasing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
attached	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
absence	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Cumulative speaking challenge

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

Words I used: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____	Self-assessment: How naturally did you use the words? ☐ Very naturally ☐ Mostly well ☐ Needs more practice Notes: _____ _____ _____
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Unit 7 · Habits · The architecture of habits

Every habit has a structure. Researchers who study behaviour have found that most habits follow the same pattern: a cue triggers a routine, and the routine is followed by a reward. Understanding this structure is the key to changing habits you don't want and building ones you do.

The cue can be almost anything, a time of day, a location, an emotion, a person, or an action that precedes the habit. If you smoke when you drink coffee, the coffee is the cue. If you check your phone when you feel bored, boredom is the cue.

To change a habit, researchers suggest keeping the cue and the reward the same, but changing the routine in the middle. If stress makes you eat junk food, identify a different routine that gives you a similar reward, like going for a walk or calling a friend.

Building new habits takes patience. Research suggests that it takes an average of 66 days to form a new habit, not the commonly cited 21 days. Small habits, consistently practised, compound over time into remarkable results. The key is to focus not on the outcome, but on becoming the kind of person who does that thing.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
architecture	<i>noun</i>	The structure or design of something complex	<i>The architecture of habits is predictable.</i>
trigger	<i>verb</i>	To cause something to start	<i>Stress can trigger bad habits.</i>
precede	<i>verb</i>	To come before something in time	<i>A cue precedes every habit.</i>
identify	<i>verb</i>	To recognise or find something specific	<i>Identify your cues and triggers.</i>
consistently	<i>adverb</i>	In the same way every time; without variation	<i>Practise consistently for results.</i>
compound	<i>verb</i>	To grow or accumulate by building on itself	<i>Good habits compound over time.</i>
remarkable	<i>adjective</i>	Unusual and impressive; worthy of attention	<i>Consistency leads to remarkable results.</i>
outcome	<i>noun</i>	The final result of a process	<i>Focus on the process, not the outcome.</i>
cited	<i>verb (past p.)</i>	Mentioned or referred to as an example	<i>The commonly cited figure is wrong.</i>
pattern	<i>noun</i>	A regular and repeated way that something happens	<i>Habits follow a predictable pattern.</i>
behaviour	<i>noun</i>	The way a person or animal acts	<i>Understanding behaviour helps you change it.</i>

suggest	<i>verb</i>	To put forward an idea or recommendation	<i>Researchers suggest starting small.</i>
average	<i>noun</i>	The typical or middle amount	<i>It takes an average of 66 days.</i>
patience	<i>noun</i>	The ability to wait without getting frustrated	<i>Changing habits requires patience.</i>
structure	<i>noun</i>	The way something is organised or built	<i>Habits have a clear structure.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
architecture	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
trigger	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
precede	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
identify	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
consistently	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
compound	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
remarkable	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
outcome	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
cited	<i>verb (past p.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
pattern	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
behaviour	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
suggest	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
average	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
patience	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
structure	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	Complete → move to next unit

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1 Describe a habit you have tried to build or break. What happened?

2	What are your cues for habits you want to change?
3	Why do you think it is so hard to change habits even when we know we should?
4	What small habit, if done consistently, would make the biggest difference in your life?

Grammar focus

Not ... but, contrasting two ideas

The passage uses 'not ... but' to clarify a contrast: 'not on the outcome, but on becoming the kind of person...'. This structure is powerful for expressing what something is NOT and what it IS.

Examples from the passage context:

- Not about willpower, but about structure.
- Focus not on the goal, but on the daily process.
- It's not what you do once, but what you do consistently.
- Not how long, but how often.

Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'not ... but' to contrast two ideas about habits, learning, or life.

Write your answers here:

Unit 8 · Purpose · Finding your why

Many people go through periods where they feel that their life lacks direction or meaning. They are busy, perhaps very busy, but they do not feel like what they are doing truly matters. This feeling often points to a lack of purpose.

Purpose is different from goals. Goals are things you want to achieve. Purpose is the reason behind those goals, the why that makes them feel worth pursuing. A goal might be to earn more money; the purpose behind it could be to provide security for your family, or to have the freedom to do work you love.

Researchers have found that people with a strong sense of purpose tend to be healthier, more resilient, and more satisfied with their lives. They also recover more quickly from setbacks, because they have a reason to keep going.

You do not need a grand, world-changing purpose. Most people's purpose is found in everyday relationships, in the work they do well, or in the communities they contribute to. The key is to reflect on what makes you feel most alive, and do more of it.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
purpose	<i>noun</i>	The reason you do something; the meaning behind your actions	<i>She found purpose in teaching.</i>
lacks	<i>verb</i>	Does not have enough of something	<i>The plan lacks detail.</i>
pursuing	<i>verb</i>	Actively working towards something	<i>She is pursuing her dream.</i>
security	<i>noun</i>	The state of being safe and protected	<i>Financial security matters to me.</i>
resilient	<i>adjective</i>	Able to recover quickly from difficulties	<i>Resilient people don't give up easily.</i>
satisfied	<i>adjective</i>	Content and pleased with your situation	<i>Are you satisfied with your life?</i>
grand	<i>adjective</i>	Large and impressive in scale or ambition	<i>You don't need a grand plan.</i>
contribute	<i>verb</i>	To give or add something to a group or effort	<i>How do you contribute to your community?</i>
reflect	<i>verb</i>	To think carefully about something	<i>Take time to reflect on what matters.</i>
alive	<i>adjective</i>	Full of energy and meaning; vital	<i>What makes you feel most alive?</i>
freedom	<i>noun</i>	The power to act, speak, or think freely	<i>Purpose gives you inner freedom.</i>
tends to	<i>phrase</i>	Usually does; is likely to	<i>Purpose tends to come from relationships.</i>
direction	<i>noun</i>	A clear sense of where you are going or what to do	<i>I need more direction in my career.</i>
meaning	<i>noun</i>	A sense of significance and importance	<i>She found meaning in her work.</i>

periods	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Lengths of time with a particular quality	<i>Everyone goes through difficult periods.</i>
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Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
purpose	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
lacks	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
pursuing	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
security	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
resilient	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
satisfied	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
grand	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
contribute	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
reflect	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
alive	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
freedom	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
tends to	<i>phrase</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
direction	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
meaning	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
periods	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	What gives your life the most meaning right now?
2	How is your sense of purpose different from your goals?
3	Have you ever been very busy but felt empty or purposeless? What was that like?
4	What would you do differently if you had a clearer sense of purpose?

Grammar focus

Relative clauses with 'which', 'who', 'where'

Relative clauses add information about a noun. 'Who' for people, 'which' for things, 'where' for places. They can be defining (no commas) or non-defining (with commas, adding extra info).

Examples from the passage context:

- People who have purpose recover faster.
- The work which she does gives her meaning.
- This is a period where direction matters.
- Her purpose, which was helping others, drove everything.

Practice task:

Write 4 sentences using relative clauses ('who', 'which', 'where') about people, things, or situations.

Write your answers here:

Unit 9 · Mindfulness · The present moment

Most of us spend very little time actually in the present. Our minds are busy thinking about what happened yesterday or planning what to do tomorrow. We are physically in the room, but mentally we are somewhere else entirely.

Mindfulness is the practice of deliberately paying attention to what is happening right now, in your body, your mind, and your surroundings, without judgement. It sounds simple, but it is one of the most difficult things to do consistently.

The science behind mindfulness is well established. Regular practice has been shown to reduce anxiety, improve concentration, and increase emotional regulation. Many schools, hospitals, and corporations now incorporate mindfulness into their programmes.

But you do not need a guided meditation app to be mindful. Mindfulness can happen during any activity, eating, walking, washing dishes, as long as you bring your full attention to that moment. The next time you eat a meal, try putting down your phone and just eating. Notice the texture, the temperature, the taste. That is mindfulness.

The mind will wander. That is natural. Mindfulness is simply the practice of noticing when it has wandered, and gently bringing it back.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
deliberately	<i>adverb</i>	On purpose; intentionally	<i>She deliberately chose to slow down.</i>
judgement	<i>noun</i>	An opinion or assessment; the act of evaluating	<i>Observe your thoughts without judgement.</i>
established	<i>adjective</i>	Accepted and confirmed; well-known to be true	<i>The science is well established.</i>
anxiety	<i>noun</i>	A feeling of worry and nervousness	<i>Mindfulness reduces anxiety.</i>
concentration	<i>noun</i>	The ability to focus your attention	<i>Sleep improves concentration.</i>
regulation	<i>noun</i>	The process of controlling or managing something	<i>Emotional regulation is a key skill.</i>
incorporate	<i>verb</i>	To include something as part of a larger whole	<i>Incorporate rest into your routine.</i>
guided	<i>adjective</i>	Led or directed by someone or something	<i>Try a guided meditation.</i>
texture	<i>noun</i>	The feel or consistency of a surface or substance	<i>Notice the texture of your food.</i>
wander	<i>verb</i>	To move without a fixed direction; (of the mind) to lose focus	<i>The mind naturally wanders.</i>
gently	<i>adverb</i>	Softly and without force or harshness	<i>Gently return your attention.</i>

surroundings	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Everything around you; your environment	<i>Be aware of your surroundings.</i>
physically	<i>adverb</i>	In terms of the body; in a bodily sense	<i>You are physically here but not present.</i>
mentally	<i>adverb</i>	In terms of the mind and thoughts	<i>She was mentally exhausted.</i>
practice	<i>noun</i>	Regular exercise of an activity to improve	<i>Mindfulness is a daily practice.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
deliberately	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
judgement	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
established	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
anxiety	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
concentration	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
regulation	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
incorporate	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
guided	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
texture	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
wander	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
gently	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
surroundings	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
physically	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
mentally	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
practice	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1 When do you find it hardest to stay present? What distracts your mind most?

2	Have you ever tried mindfulness or meditation? What was your experience?
3	How do you think mindfulness could help you in your daily life or work?
4	What is one everyday activity you could do more mindfully?

Grammar focus

Passive with 'has been shown to' / 'has been found to'

Scientific and research-based writing often uses passive structures: 'has been shown to reduce anxiety', 'has been found to improve'. These are passive present perfect structures meaning 'research shows that...'

Examples from the passage context:

- Mindfulness has been shown to reduce stress.
- Sleep has been found to improve memory.
- Exercise has been shown to boost mood.
- Meditation has been found to increase focus.

Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'has been shown to' or 'has been found to' about health, learning, or behaviour.

Write your answers here:

Review Unit 3

Recycling vocabulary from Unit 7, Unit 8, Unit 9

Mixed tracking grid

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

Word	1	2	3	4	5	Sentence using the word
architecture	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
identify	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
remarkable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
pattern	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
average	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
purpose	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
security	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
grand	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
alive	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
direction	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
deliberately	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
anxiety	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
incorporate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
wander	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
physically	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Cumulative speaking challenge

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

Words I used:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

7. _____

8. _____

Self-assessment:

How naturally did you use the words?

☐ Very naturally ☐ Mostly well ☐ Needs more practice

Notes:

Unit 10 · Change · Why change is hard

Change is something most people say they want. But when change actually arrives, invited or not, it often feels threatening. Why is it so hard to change, even when we know that change would be good for us?

Psychologists point to several reasons. One is the comfort of the familiar. Our brains are wired to favour routine and predictability. Change, by definition, introduces uncertainty, and uncertainty activates our threat response, the same system that evolved to protect us from physical danger.

Another reason is identity. We often define ourselves by what we do and how we live. A significant change, in career, relationship, or lifestyle, can feel like a loss of self, not just a change of circumstance.

But change is also the mechanism through which growth happens. People who adapt well to change are not people who feel no discomfort, they simply learn to move through discomfort rather than avoid it. They understand that the discomfort is temporary, and that on the other side of it, there is almost always something valuable.

The most powerful thing you can do when faced with unavoidable change is to focus not on what you are losing, but on what you are becoming.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
threatening	<i>adjective</i>	Making you feel that something bad will happen	<i>Change can feel threatening.</i>
familiar	<i>adjective</i>	Known and comfortable; not new or strange	<i>We stick to the familiar.</i>
predictability	<i>noun</i>	The quality of always happening in the same way	<i>Brains love predictability.</i>
uncertainty	<i>noun</i>	The state of not knowing what will happen	<i>Change brings uncertainty.</i>
activates	<i>verb</i>	Starts or triggers a process or system	<i>Stress activates the threat response.</i>
evolved	<i>verb (past)</i>	Developed over a long period	<i>This instinct evolved for survival.</i>
circumstance	<i>noun</i>	A fact or condition connected to an event	<i>External circumstances change.</i>
mechanism	<i>noun</i>	A process or system that produces a result	<i>Pain is a mechanism for learning.</i>
discomfort	<i>noun</i>	A feeling of unease or mild pain	<i>Growth requires discomfort.</i>
temporary	<i>adjective</i>	Lasting for only a short time	<i>The discomfort is temporary.</i>
unavoidable	<i>adjective</i>	Impossible to prevent or escape	<i>Some change is unavoidable.</i>
define	<i>verb</i>	To describe or explain the nature of something	<i>How do you define yourself?</i>

significant	<i>adjective</i>	Large and important in effect or meaning	<i>A significant change happened.</i>
valuable	<i>adjective</i>	Worth a lot; highly useful or important	<i>The experience was valuable.</i>
faced with	<i>phrase</i>	Having to deal with a difficult situation	<i>Faced with change, she adapted.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
threatening	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
familiar	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
predictability	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
uncertainty	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
activates	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
evolved	<i>verb (past)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
circumstance	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
mechanism	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
discomfort	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
temporary	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
unavoidable	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
define	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
significant	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
valuable	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
faced with	<i>phrase</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	Talk about a significant change in your life. How did you feel at first?
2	Do you think you handle change well? Why or why not?
3	What strategies help you cope with unexpected change?

Grammar focus

Not ... but, correction and clarification

The passage uses 'not ... but' to correct a common assumption: 'not people who feel no discomfort, they simply learn to move through discomfort rather than avoid it.' This is a very effective rhetorical tool.

Examples from the passage context:

- Not avoiding discomfort, but moving through it.
- Not about what you lose, but what you become.
- Not a loss of self, but a change of circumstance.
- Not the change itself, but your reaction to it.

Practice task:

Write 3 sentences that correct a common misunderstanding about change, habits, or identity using 'not ... but'.

Write your answers here:

Unit 11 · Relationships · The art of listening

Most of us believe we are good listeners. We are not. Research consistently shows that the average person remembers only about 25% of what they hear in a conversation. We are physically present, but our minds are often preparing our next response, thinking about something unrelated, or filtering what we hear through our own assumptions and judgements.

Real listening, what psychologists call active listening, is a very different skill. It requires you to be fully present, to resist the urge to interrupt or offer solutions, and to focus entirely on what the other person is experiencing, not just what they are saying.

When someone feels truly listened to, something significant happens. They feel less alone. They gain clarity about their own thoughts, because the act of being heard helps them articulate what they feel. And paradoxically, they often solve their own problems, simply by talking them through with someone who listens well.

The most generous thing you can offer another person is not advice, money, or time. It is your undivided attention. In a world of constant distraction, truly listening to someone is an act of profound respect.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
consistently	<i>adverb</i>	Always in the same way; repeatedly	<i>Research consistently shows this.</i>
filtering	<i>verb</i>	Selecting or removing things based on criteria	<i>We filter what we hear.</i>
assumptions	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Things believed to be true without proof	<i>Don't make assumptions.</i>
active	<i>adjective</i>	Engaged and participatory; not passive	<i>Active listening is a skill.</i>
interrupt	<i>verb</i>	To stop someone while they are speaking	<i>Don't interrupt, wait your turn.</i>
articulate	<i>verb</i>	To express thoughts or feelings clearly	<i>He struggled to articulate his feelings.</i>
paradoxically	<i>adverb</i>	In a way that seems contradictory but is true	<i>Paradoxically, less is sometimes more.</i>
undivided	<i>adjective</i>	Complete and not shared with anything else	<i>Give them your undivided attention.</i>
profound	<i>adjective</i>	Deep and significant; not superficial	<i>Listening is an act of profound respect.</i>
clarity	<i>noun</i>	The quality of being clear and easy to understand	<i>Talking gives us clarity.</i>
presence	<i>noun</i>	The state of being mentally and physically here	<i>Your presence is a gift.</i>
generous	<i>adjective</i>	Willing to give more than necessary	<i>Being a good listener is generous.</i>

unrelated	<i>adjective</i>	Having no connection to the subject	<i>My mind drifted to unrelated things.</i>
solutions	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Answers to problems	<i>We often want to jump to solutions.</i>
experiencing	<i>verb</i>	Going through or living something	<i>Focus on what they are experiencing.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
consistently	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
filtering	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
assumptions	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
active	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
interrupt	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
articulate	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
paradoxically	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
undivided	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
profound	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
clarity	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
presence	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
generous	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
unrelated	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
solutions	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
experiencing	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	<i>Complete → move to next unit</i>

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	Do you think you are a good listener? Be honest, what are your weaknesses?
2	Talk about someone who is a great listener. What do they do differently?
3	When was the last time you felt truly listened to? How did it feel?

Why do you think people often try to give advice instead of just listening?

Grammar focus

Not just ... but also, adding emphasis

We use 'not just ... but also' to emphasise that something does more than one thing: 'not just what they are saying, but also what they are experiencing'. This is a sophisticated connective.

Examples from the passage context:

- Not just present, but fully engaged.
- Not just listening, but also reflecting.
- She gives not just time, but also genuine attention.
- It helps not just the speaker, but also the listener.

Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'not just ... but also' about communication, learning, or relationships.

Write your answers here:

Unit 12 · Time · The feeling of never having enough

'I don't have enough time.' It is perhaps the most common complaint of modern life. Yet for most people reading this, time is not actually the problem. Priorities are.

We make time for what matters most to us, even if we tell ourselves otherwise. The person who says they have no time to exercise often spends two hours scrolling through their phone each evening. The question is not whether you have time. It is what you are choosing to spend it on.

That said, modern life does impose real demands. The boundaries between work and rest have blurred. Technology means you are reachable at all hours. The pace of information has accelerated to the point where rest feels like a risk.

The antidote is not a perfect time management system. It is a clearer relationship with your own priorities. Ask yourself: if I had only three hours of productive time today, what would I absolutely do? Then do those things first, and protect that time aggressively.

Time cannot be saved. It can only be spent. The question is who and what you are spending it on.

Vocabulary

Word	Part of speech	Meaning in context	Example
complaint	<i>noun</i>	An expression of dissatisfaction or unhappiness	<i>A common complaint is feeling rushed.</i>
impose	<i>verb</i>	To force something on someone or something	<i>Work imposes demands on your time.</i>
blurred	<i>verb (past)</i>	Made unclear or less distinct	<i>The boundaries between work and rest have blurred.</i>
reachable	<i>adjective</i>	Able to be contacted	<i>I'm not always reachable by phone.</i>
accelerated	<i>verb (past)</i>	Increased in speed	<i>The pace of life has accelerated.</i>
antidote	<i>noun</i>	Something that prevents or counteracts something bad	<i>Rest is an antidote to burnout.</i>
productive	<i>adjective</i>	Achieving a lot in a useful way	<i>I have two productive hours in the morning.</i>
absolutely	<i>adverb</i>	Without doubt; completely and definitely	<i>What would you absolutely do?</i>
aggressively	<i>adverb</i>	With force and determination	<i>Protect your time aggressively.</i>
priorities	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Things considered most important	<i>Know your priorities clearly.</i>
demands	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Things that require effort or attention	<i>Modern life makes many demands.</i>
boundaries	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	Limits between different areas or roles	<i>Set boundaries around your work time.</i>
pace	<i>noun</i>	The speed at which something happens	<i>The pace of modern life is too fast.</i>

otherwise	<i>adverb</i>	In a different way; or else	<i>We tell ourselves otherwise.</i>
modern	<i>adjective</i>	Relating to the present time; contemporary	<i>Modern life is full of distractions.</i>

Word-tracking grid

Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

Word	Part of speech	1	2	3	4	5	Uses	Example I used it
complaint	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
impose	<i>verb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
blurred	<i>verb (past)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
reachable	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
accelerated	<i>verb (past)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
antidote	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
productive	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
absolutely	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
aggressively	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
priorities	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
demands	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
boundaries	<i>noun (pl.)</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
pace	<i>noun</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
otherwise	<i>adverb</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
modern	<i>adjective</i>	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_/5	
Total							_/75	Complete → move to next unit

Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

1	Where does most of your time actually go? Is it where you want it to go?
2	Do you have clear boundaries between work and rest? How do you protect them?
3	What would you do if you had only three truly productive hours today?

4 Is 'I don't have time' usually an honest answer or an excuse?

Grammar focus

Conditionals with 'if', real and hypothetical

The passage uses a conditional: 'if I had only three hours... what would I absolutely do?' This is a hypothetical (second) conditional using past tense + would. Real conditionals use present tense + will.

Examples from the passage context:

- If I had more time, I would sleep more.
- If you protect your mornings, you will be more productive.
- If they had fewer distractions, they could focus.
- If time is limited, use it on what matters most.

Practice task:

Write 3 conditional sentences (real or hypothetical) about how you would use time differently.

Write your answers here:

Review Unit 4

Recycling vocabulary from Unit 10, Unit 11, Unit 12

Mixed tracking grid

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

Word	1	2	3	4	5	Sentence using the word
threatening	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
uncertainty	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
circumstance	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
temporary	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
significant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
consistently	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
active	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
paradoxically	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
clarity	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
unrelated	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
complaint	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
reachable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
productive	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
priorities	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
pace	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Cumulative speaking challenge

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

Words I used: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____	Self-assessment: How naturally did you use the words? ☐ Very naturally ☐ Mostly well ☐ Needs more practice Notes: _____ _____ _____
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Student's guide

How to use this book

Read to Speak is built around active vocabulary acquisition. Each unit introduces 15 target words through a meaningful passage, then guides learners to use those words in real conversation before marking them as learned. The word-tracking grid is the engine of this method.

The word-tracking method

The core principle is simple: a word is not learned until it has been used, not studied, not recognised, but genuinely used, at least 5 times in real conversation. The checkbox system makes this visible and motivating.

Using the passages

Read the passage aloud with learners before studying vocabulary. Ask comprehension questions about meaning and tone. Discuss the topic before introducing the word list, learners should engage with the ideas, not just the language.

Speaking prompts

These prompts are designed to be impossible to answer without using the unit vocabulary. Push learners beyond single-word answers. Model extended responses. Encourage learners to ask each other follow-up questions.

Grammar focus

Each grammar point is drawn from the passage itself, not added artificially. Show learners the point in context first. The practice task is intentionally open-ended, accept any grammatically correct response.

Review units

These appear after every 3 units. They recycle vocabulary from the previous 3 units. Do not introduce new vocabulary during review units. Use the self-assessment section for learner reflection.

For self-study learners

Self-study learners should find a conversation partner, a friend, tutor, or language exchange partner, to complete the speaking components. The word-tracking grid works perfectly for solo conversation practice with a partner.

Adapting for different learners

For stronger learners, encourage use of the vocabulary across topics, not just in direct response to the prompts. For weaker learners, allow use of the word in a simpler sentence before building up.

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